

[Return to Search](#)

Gods and goods in Africa

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Section Title(S)

2. The nineteenth century (Ca. 1890) • 3. The colonial period (to 1960)

Ethnic relations tended to be much the same in the nineteenth century as they had been in the earlier period, with the exceptions noted above. The Fulani tended to have the prestige attached to successful conquerors. Islam increased in prestige and the number of people becoming Muslims can safely be assumed to have increased. The Dukawa, who were victims of Fulani slave raids throughout the nineteenth century, resented both Islam and the Fulani. Their marriage patterns tended to keep them separate from other groups in the area, and their culture tended to be antithetical to Islam in general and Fulani in particular.

563
[Ethnic Stratification](#)

The Kamberi tended to develop their "docility" in the nineteenth century as a result of the slave raids and their defeat at the hand of the Fulani adventurer Sambo (Balogun 1970:126; Mahdi, personal communication). They lost a large number of personnel in their resistance to Sambo and the slave raids. By adopting a non-aggressive attitude they seem to have lost a great deal of prestige. The Dukawa, their closest friends, have tended to look down on the Kamberi for their "shyness" even while maintaining their joking relationship (abokin wasar) with them.

563
[Ethnic Stratification](#)

3. The colonial period (to 1960)

The British tended to reinforce existing ethnic relations in Yauri. They confirmed the political power of the ruling group as well  -122- as its consequent economic privileges and, in fact, strengthened and expanded both

181
[Ethos](#)

the political and economic power of the local emir (Crowder 1966:244-246). The strengthening of the ruling group tended to increase the movement of other peoples into that group. By the end of the colonial period, the identification of "Islam" and "Hausa" was almost complete in Yauri.

565

[Classes](#)

626

[Social Control](#)

648

[External Relations](#)

771

[General Character Of Religion](#)

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